

Azim Premji Chairman, Wipro, on becoming the richest man in India

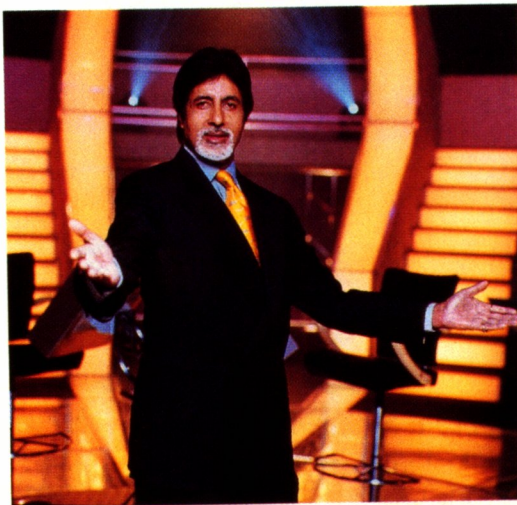
"I feel like a zoo animal these days. My privacy has been invaded."



Andhra Pradesh's Karnam Malleswari won a bronze at the Sydney Olympics for weight lifting in the women's 69 kg category. The 25-year-old became the first Indian woman to win an Olympic medal. Criticised for being overweight and shadowed by charges of doping, Malleswari went on to win the coveted Padma Shri and the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna award.

LOCK KIYA JAYE?

India found its new favourite tagline when *Kaun Banega Crorepati* debuted with Amitabh Bachchan as the host. The show that saw contenders trying for the Rs 1-crore jackpot entered three crore TV homes in 18 months and made Rs 135 crore from ad sales.



And The Three Ruled the Galaxy

Beauty is subjective, they say. But for one golden year, India set the standard for the world, as Lara Dutta became Miss Universe, Priyanka Chopra Miss World and Diya Mirza Miss Asia-Pacific. Aditi Govitrikar got the Mrs World title. Dutta and Chopra subsequently starred in a movie together, *Andaz*, solidifying Bollywood as a destination for beauty queens.



WORLD BEATERS: (from left) Govitrikar, Chopra and Dutta pose together

ELSEWHERE...

- Pope John Paul II began the first official visit by a Roman Catholic pontiff to Israel.
- Hugo Chávez was re-elected as Venezuela's president with a 59 per cent vote.
- An Air France Flight 4590 crashed into a hotel in Genesee just after taking off from Paris, killing 113.
- Presidential elections were held in Russia and Vladimir Putin (below) became President.



5,740

was the mark the Sensex touched in February, the highest for that year, before crashing to 3,711 in October. It ended the year with a loss of 26 per cent, caused by the technology, media and telecom sectors.